

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	C – Case Processing
	Section No./Name	C-200-FITAP-SNAP Clearances
	Document No./Name	C-210-SNAP National Accuracy Clearinghouse (NAC)
	Effective Date	August 1, 2024

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

The National Accuracy Clearinghouse (NAC) is a nationwide data matching system designed to enhance program integrity by providing state agencies with a tool to screen for duplicate participation in Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) so that an individual does not receive SNAP benefits in more than one state at any time. NAC ensures that timely action is taken to reduce incorrect SNAP, including Louisiana Combined Application Project (LaCAP), benefit issuances when an individual applies for SNAP in another state. NAC can only be used to prevent duplicate participation in SNAP. Information from the NAC cannot be used to determine eligibility for Family Independence Temporary Assistance Program (FITAP) or Kinship Care Subsidy Program (KCSP) cases. All states and territories are required to utilize NAC. It will be implemented in a phased approach over a 5-year period.

C-211-SNAP – PO NAC PROCESS OVERVIEW

NAC is queried for all household members at application, redetermination, and when adding a new household member. The state that submits a query in NAC is considered the Initiating State. The state that has the NAC Match is considered the Matching State. A NAC Match means that an individual has been identified as currently receiving benefits in one state and is applying for benefits in another state. Louisiana can be either the Initiating State or the Matching State. In either situation, if a NAC Match of duplicate participation is identified, action must be taken to clear the match. When Louisiana is the **Initiating State**, a query is submitted to the NAC Web Application during application, redetermination, or when adding a new household member, which may result in a NAC Match being found for duplicate participation in another state. A query is completed through the Clearance Summary or On-Demand.

Identity, residency, and Social Security Numbers (SSN) must be verified prior to conducting a query in NAC. If all three are not verified initially in Data Collection, the Clearance Summary will not run the query. Once the identity, residency, and Social Security Number are verified for the head of household and the SSNs verified for all other household members, a NAC On-Demand query must be sent to receive NAC results in the Clearance Summary for the head of household and/or household members.

When NAC finds a match, the NAC Web Application will create a Match Record in the NAC Web Application with a unique 'Match ID' to identify it. NAC will send both the Initiating and Matching states an email notification of the match, which includes the 'Match ID' that is linked to the Match Record. If no match is found, the NAC Web Application notifies the Initiating State that no match was found. If an On-Demand query is run and there is no match found, a case note must be made indicating that the NAC query was conducted and no match was found. The worker will continue the eligibility determination process in accordance with policy.

When Louisiana is the **Matching State**, an email notification is sent from the NAC Web Application indicating a NAC Match was found advising that an individual who is receiving SNAP in Louisiana is applying for benefits in another state. This may mean the household has moved to another state

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without closing their case in Louisiana making their Louisiana residency questionable. Current residency in Louisiana must be verified prior to denying or closing the case if the member is the head of household or excluding the household member if the member is not the head of household.

An email notification from the NAC Web Application is sent to DCFS.NAC mailbox that Fraud and Recovery Unit (FRU) support staff will receive. The email advises that an individual has applied for benefits in that state and will include the 'Match ID' and the 'Match Date'. FRU support staff is responsible for monitoring the email box and notifying staff that a NAC match has been received by creating a **NAC Task**. Refer to C-213-PR for FRU's responsibilities when Louisiana is the Matching State and a NAC Match is received.

C-212-SNAP – PO NAC TERMINOLOGY

The terms below assist when processing a case with a NAC Match.

- **NAC Web Application** – the system used by participating NAC states regarding duplicate SNAP participation to view and search information on matches, make necessary updates, and take actions.
- **NAC Match** – indicates an individual is receiving benefits in another state. NAC matches for active SNAP participants are received daily from the NAC Web Service.
- **Match Record** – created when NAC finds a match for duplicate participation in another state.
- **Match ID** – an identifier to allow States to communicate with each other about the match outside the NAC Web Application (such as by email) without using Personally Identifiable Information (PII).
- **Match Date** – the date a NAC Match was received.
- **Initiating State** – the state that receives a NAC Match indicating possible duplicate participation as a result of a client applying for benefits or adding a new household member in Louisiana.
- **Matching State** – the state that receives a NAC Match indicating possible duplicate participation from the initiating state or directly from the NAC Web Application as a result of a new applicant or the addition of a new household member.
- **NAC Data Matching Elements** – can be used to search for SNAP participants in the NAC Web Application; these elements are the participant's name, date of birth, and SSN.
- **Participant ID or Individual ID** – A unique identifier for a participant or applicant that each State will connect a match to the appropriate individual in their own State system; this is the Person ID (PID) in LITE.
- **Vulnerable Individual** – a person who would be endangered by the circulation of their information as a result of a domestic violent situation. Ex. Individual living in a battered woman's shelter or identifies as fleeing from domestic violence.
- **Invalid Match** – involves participants who are not receiving or applying for benefits in more than one state and may occur if there has been an error in the information submitted to the NAC or in cases of identity theft.

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- **Initial Action Taken** – the first action taken by the Initiating State and Matching State to resolve a match; **must be** completed within ten days of receiving a match notification of possible duplicate participation. The Initial Action Taken options change depending on whether the state is the Initiating State or the Matching State.
- **Initial Investigation** – task status when FRU staff enter details for match results reported from the NAC Web Application.
- **No Interface Triggered** – If NAC was not able to be called because identity, residency, or SSN was not verified, then the record will appear on Clearance Summary as “No Interface Triggered”.
- **Final Disposition Taken** – the final result after the Initiating or Matching state has resolved a match of possible duplicate participation.

C-213-SNAP – PO PROCESSING EXPEDITED CASES WITH NAC MATCH

Expedited timeframe does not apply:

- If a NAC Match is received and it is verified that benefits are currently being receiving benefits in another state, by either a household member or the entire household.
 - If it is verified a ‘matched’ individual is receiving benefits in another state, the individual must be excluded from the case and expedited benefits issued to the remaining members of the household.

Expedited timeframe applies:

- If a NAC Match is found and it is verified a household member is not receiving benefits in another state, expedited benefits must be issued.
- If a NAC Match is found but is not able to be resolved timely, expedited benefits must be issued.
- If the worker is unable to submit a NAC query due to postponed verification, the household is eligible to receive expedited benefits for the initial and second month, if applicable.
 - If during the 30-day processing period, residency and Social Security Number are verified, the NAC query is submitted and a match is found, the worker must follow procedures in C-212-SNAP PR, for a NAC Match.

If the household fails to respond to the OFS 14 NAC notice within 10 days, or if the State determines the matched individual is receiving benefits in another State, the Notice of Decision must be sent. While the notice is sent to the head of household, only the ‘matched’ individuals are denied and not the remaining household members.

C-214-SNAP – PO MONTHLY BULK MATCH REPORT

The Monthly Bulk Match (MBM) Report runs every second Tuesday of each month around 6:00 am ET. This report looks at all SNAP participants in all participating States’ most recent bulk upload and cross references to find individuals already receiving SNAP benefits that were not found through a

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query match. Each month, after the MBM report runs, FRU staff will receive an email notification advising the MBM report is available and the number of matches found. If there were zero matches found, an email is sent advising of no matches. If matches are indicated in the email, select the 'View MBM Report' button in the email to navigate to the NAC Web Application. Use the 'Match ID' link on the MBM Report to access the match details. Refer to section C-213-SNAP – PR for procedures.

II. PROCEDURES

C-211-SNAP – PR ACCESSING THE NAC WEB APPLICATION

Staff must access the NAC Web Application to update or view NAC Match details. This can be completed via the link provided in the NAC Match email notification or through the "NAC" Task in LITE by selecting the 'Match ID' link. After selecting the link from one of these options, staff will be directed to the USDA eAuthentication (eAuth) website Customer Login screen and must complete the following steps:

- Select the option Login.gov,
- Enter the Email address and Password associated with your eAuth account,
- Select 'Sign-In', and enter the one-time code sent via text message,
- Select 'Submit' to access the NAC Web Application.
 - Selecting 'Submit' navigates staff to the **Find a SNAP Participant** screen in the NAC Web Application.

Within the **Find a SNAP Participant** screen, staff can conduct searches for an individual to verify if there is duplicate participation in SNAP in other states. Staff must use caution when conducting a search on the **Find a SNAP Participant** screen because if there is no existing match, a new match will be created as a result of the search. To conduct a search for an individual SNAP participant on the **Find a SNAP Participant** screen and view a Match Record, staff must:

- Enter the Last Name, Date of Birth, Social Security Number, Participant ID (PID in LITE), and a Search Reason (New Application, New Household Member, Recertification, or Other) then select 'Search',
- If a match is not found, the following message will display: *"No Matches Found – There are no match records for this participant."* Matches are only on exact values. Information entered incorrectly will result in no match results.
- If a match is found, the SNAP Participants Search Results will display the 'Match ID', 'Matching State', and 'Vulnerable Individual' information.
 - **Note:** It is possible to have multiple matches for a single individual.
- Select the 'Match ID' link in the SNAP Participants Search Results to navigate to the **Match Record** screen.
- Enter response details for either the 'Initial Action' or 'Final Disposition', and
- Select 'Save Changes'.

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Staff can also access the NAC Web Application to search for an open match and make updates to the 'Match Record'. To conduct a search for an open match and update the 'Match Record' in the NAC Web Application, staff must:

- Navigate to the NAC Web Application,
- Select the '**Find An Existing Match**' tab in the top navigation panel, and
- On the **Find an Existing Match** screen, select one of the following search options:
 - Match ID
 - Participant ID
 - Case Number
 - Last Name, Date of Birth, and Social Security Number.
- The **Match Record** screen displays the Vulnerable and Invalid Status questions, the Initial Action details, and the Final Disposition details as fields to be updated.
- If the individual is flagged as a Vulnerable Individual, an alert will populate. Click Continue to proceed.
- The **Match Record** screen also displays read-only information for the Matching State and Initiating State that includes the SNAP Participant Information, Match Information, and Contact Information of each state included in the Match Record.
- Select 'Save Changes' to complete the update once all the required updates have been entered on the Match Record.
 - An automatic email notification is sent to notify the Initiating/Matching State of changes made to the Match Record.

Note: A combination of Invalid Match and entering 'Final Disposition' information will result in the closure of the Match once both States provide their 'Final Disposition'. Once closed, the Match Record cannot be updated and can only be viewed in Read-Only mode.

The 'Initial Action Taken' and 'Final Disposition Taken' options displayed depend on whether the Louisiana is the Initiating State or the Matching State.

- 'Initial Action Taken'
 - Initiating State options are:
 - Notice Sent - a SNAP Participation Match in Another State (OFS 14 NAC) notice is sent to the household to inform the client of the NAC match.
 - Client Provided Required Verification – the client submitted the requested verification to verify Louisiana residency.
 - Matching State options:
 - Notice Sent - a SNAP Participation Match in Another State (OFS 14 NAC) notice is sent to the household to inform the client of the NAC match.
 - Client Verified Move out of State – verification received from the client verifying the household no longer resides in Louisiana.

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- ‘Final Disposition Taken’
 - Initiating State options are:
 - Benefits Approved – the case has been approved and benefits issued.
 - Benefits Denied – the case has been denied.
 - Matching State options:
 - Benefits Terminated – the case has been closed and the client is no longer receiving benefits.
 - Benefits Unchanged – no action was taken to terminate benefits.

C-212-SNAP – PR LOUISIANA AS THE INITIATING STATE

When Louisiana is the Initiating State, a query is submitted to the NAC Web Application when completing an application, a redetermination, adding a household member, or when calling NAC On-Demand. During *Data Collection*, the NAC query is automatically submitted after verifying the identity, residency, and Social Security Number of the head of household and the Social Security Numbers of additional household members when continuing from the **Person Demographics – Details** screen.

If a NAC Match is found, the NAC Match will be displayed in the Clearance Summary. Information received from the NAC Match is automatically added to the **Out-of-State Benefits – Details** screen in LITE by creating a new record. This results in an automatic case note generated stating “*Out-of-State record added for individual (PID) due to NAC match.*” LITE automatically populates the following information in the **Out-of-State Benefits – Details** screen:

- **Benefit Begin Date** - "Recent Benefit Issuance Date" from the NAC Match results, which is the last date of benefit issuance.
- **Benefit End Date** - "Participant Closing Date" from the NAC Match results which may or may not provide the benefit termination date if benefits are continuing to be received.
- **Reported On** - The date the NAC Match was found. This date might be before or after the Benefit Begin Date.
- **Benefit Received in Other State** – the program type will be SNAP.
- **State** - State ID for the state from where the benefits were received
- **Termination Verification** – Verification option will be "Pending Due to NAC Match."

If a record already exists on the **Out-of-State Benefits - Details** screen that overlaps with the new record from the NAC Match, the new record is added. Exact duplicate information is not be added to the **Out-of-State Benefits – Details** screen.

Additionally, when a NAC Match is found, a **NAC Match – Initiating State** task is automatically created and assigned to the worker (case owner) in ‘Initial Investigation’ status. The task is created when a NAC Match is found at intake, redetermination, or when a new member is added to a SNAP household. Action must be taken on the task within ten days.

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The worker (case owner) must complete the following actions once the interview is complete:

- Run Eligibility Determination and Benefit Calculation (EDBC). LITE will automatically send the **SNAP Participation Match in Another State** (OFS 14 NAC), to inform the household of the NAC Match. An automatic case note is generated stating, "*Notice of Match Result generated for individual (PID) due to a NAC match.*" The case is pended for the missing verification listed on the OFS 14 NAC. The household must provide the verification within 10 days.
 - Access the NAC Web Application and update the 'Initial Action' to "Notice Sent". If "Notice Sent" is selected, the "Initial Action Date" is populated.
 - Click "Save Changes".
- If verification of terminated out-of-state benefits is received and the Matching State terminated the benefits or the Matching State has not updated NAC Web Application, take the following actions:
 - Access LITE and navigate back to the work item and Data Collection.
 - Update the **Out-of-State Benefits – Details** screen with Termination Verification of "NAC - Termination Verified". An automatic case note is generated stating "*Out-of-State Benefits updated to 'NAC – Termination Verified' for individual (PID).*"
 - Run EDBC and authorize the case. The case will be approved for benefits.
 - The NAC Match – Initiating State task status is automatically updated to 'Final Disposition Needed'.
 - Access the NAC Web Application and update the:
 - 'Initial Action Taken' to "Client provided Required Verification",
 - Date received, and
 - 'Final Disposition' of "Benefits Approved".
 - Manually update the NAC Match – Initiating State Task status to "Completed" in LITE.
- If verification of receipt of out-of-state benefits is received and the Matching State did not terminate the benefits or the Matching State has not updated NAC Web Application, take the following actions:
 - Access LITE and navigate back to the work item and Data Collection.
 - Remove the 'Benefits End Date' from the **Out-of-State Benefits – Details** screen.
 - The Termination Verification can remain blank and the system automatically closes the case or excludes the individual. An automatic case note is generated stating, "*Individual (PID) excluded due to Out-of-State benefits – NAC Match.*"
 - Run EDBC and authorize the case. The case is denied or closed if the household member is the head of household. The member is excluded if the member is not the head of household.
 - The NAC Match – Initiating State Task status is automatically updated to 'Final Disposition Needed'.
 - Access the NAC Web Application with the 'Final Disposition' as "Benefits Denied", and
 - Manually update the NAC Match – Initiating State Task status to "Completed."

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- If verification of terminated out-of-state benefits is not received from the household, the LITE batch process automatically closes the case if the household member is the head of household or exclude the member if the member is not the head of household.
 - The NAC Match – Initiating State Task status is automatically updated to ‘Final Disposition Needed’.
 - Update the NAC Web Application with Final Disposition as "Benefits Denied", and
 - Manually update NAC Match – Initiating State Task status to “Completed” in LITE.

C-213-SNAP – PR LOUISIANA AS THE MATCHING STATE

When Louisiana is the Matching State, the NAC Web Application sends an email notification to the DCFS NAC mailbox advising that an applicant has applied for benefits in another state.

The email address, DCFS.NAC@la.gov, has been created to accept email notifications received from the NAC Web Application. FRU staff monitor the email box and notify the staff that a NAC match has been received by creating the NAC Match for Matching State – Initiate Action Task. An automatic case note is created that displays “*NAC match received from another state for individual (PID).*”

FRU staff must complete the following steps to create a **NAC Match for Matching State – Initiate Action** task in LITE:

- Navigate to the **LITE Worker Portal Home** screen and click the ‘*Dashboard*’ tab from the top navigation panel.
- Select the new ‘Create NAC Task’ button on the **Staff Summary** screen. The ‘*Create NAC Task*’ pop-up displays.
- Enter the ‘Match ID’, ‘Match Date’, and ‘Assigned Worker’ and select ‘SAVE AND CLOSE’ to create the *NAC Match for Matching State – Initiate Action Task*,
 - The NAC Match for Matching State – Initiate Action_task is manually assigned to a FRU worker with a due date of five days after the date the match was found.
- Locate the *task* on the **Staff Summary** screen or conduct a Work Item - Task search using the ‘Match ID’ and click ‘Start Work Item’. The *NAC Task* pop-up displays.
- Select the ‘Match ID’ link in the pop-up to access the NAC Web Application. Use the ‘Match ID’ to locate the match and obtain the ‘Case ID’ and “Individual (Participant) ID”.
- Navigate back to LITE and the NAC Task pop-up and enter the ‘Case ID’ and the ‘Individual ID’ and select ‘SAVE AND CLOSE’. The NAC Match for Matching State – Initiate Action Task will automatically close and the **NAC Match – Matching State** Task will be created. The NAC Match – Matching State Task will be assigned as follows:
 - If the case is active with no pending work items (application, Simplified Report, redetermination, Change Report), the task will be assigned to FRU staff.
 - If the case is active with pending work items, the task will be assigned to the worker who is the case owner.

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For cases that are active with no pending work items, **FRU staff** must complete the following steps:

STEP 1: Select the “Start Work Item” for the NAC Match – Matching State Task on the dashboard and navigate to Initiate Data Collection to initiate a Change Report with the new NAC flag



STEP 2: Navigate to the **Person Demographics** screen and update residency verification to “NAC Match – Pending Verification”. An automatic case note is generated stating “*Pending verification of Residency due to a NAC match for individual (PID).*”

STEP 3: Run EDBC. The case (whether SNAP or LaCAP) is pending for the missing NAC verification. If the SNAP case has an associated FITAP or KCSP case, benefits will be pending based on existing eligibility rules when residency is not verified.

STEP 4: Ensure LITE sends the OFS 14 NAC that includes an Advance Notice of Adverse Action to request residency verification for the individual included in the NAC Match. The household must provide the verification of residency by the due date listed on the OFS 14 NAC (13 days). An automatic case note is generated stating “*Notice of Match Results and Adverse Action generated for individual (PID) due to a NAC Match.*”

NOTE: A Request for Verification will be sent for the FITAP/KCSP case and an OFS 14 NAC will be sent only for the SNAP case. If the worker does determine that the client moved out of state, then the FITAP case can be terminated based on the residency requirement, but an OFS 14 NAC must not be sent.

STEP 5: Access the NAC Web Application and update the ‘Initial Action’ to ‘Notice Sent’.

If verification of the Louisiana residency is received:

- Update the Residency Verification field to the appropriate selection based on the verification received. An automatic case note is generated stating “*Residency updated to ‘Meets residency requirement’ for individual (PID).*”
- Run EDBC and authorize the case. The case is approved for benefits.
- The NAC Task status is automatically updated to ‘Final Disposition Needed’.
- Navigate to the NAC Web Application and update the Final Disposition to “Benefits Unchanged”.
- Manually update the NAC Task status to “Completed” in LITE.

If verification of the Out-of-State Residency is not received:

- If the Head of Household, the LITE batch process will automatically close the case if the household member is the head of household. An automatic case note is generated stating, “Case closed for failure to provide verification due to NAC Match.”
- If a household member, manually authorize the case because the LITE batch process will not automatically exclude a household member. The LITE batch process will result in a Case Authorization Error task advising to authorize the case.

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- Access the NAC Web Application and update the ‘Final Disposition’ to “Benefits Terminated”, and
- Manually update the NAC Task status to “Completed” in LITE.

If a match is found on a closed case, the worker must update the NAC Web Application with the applicable ‘Final Disposition’.

For cases that are active with a pending work item, the **Case Owner** must complete the following steps:

STEP 1: Select the “Start Work Item” for the NAC on the dashboard and navigate to Initiate Data Collection

STEP 1A: Select “Continue previously selected action” from the dropdown in the “What action do you want to perform?” field.

STEP 1B: Follow **STEPS 2** through **STEP 5** above.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

OFS 14 NAC - SNAP Participation Match in Another State

IV. REFERENCES

7 CFR 272.18